1) Introduction

STARTING BEHIND, SLOWING DOWN.

In 2024, one in eight children started school developmentally vulnerable in two or more areas. This is the highest since 2009.

288,483 children assessed	12.5% vulnerable in two or more areas

2) Where children start behind

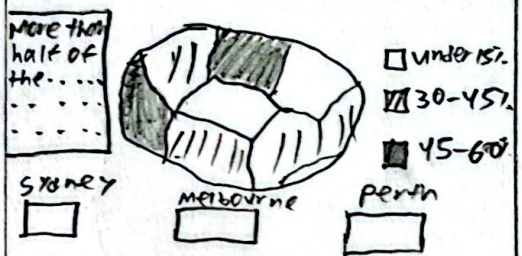


Fig 2: Choropleth map, % vulnerable by council.....

3) Where the children actually are

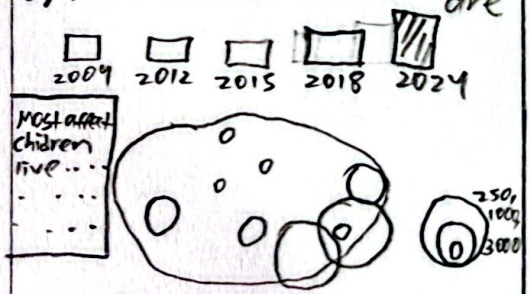


Fig 3: Proportional symbol map.....

4) Where it got worse

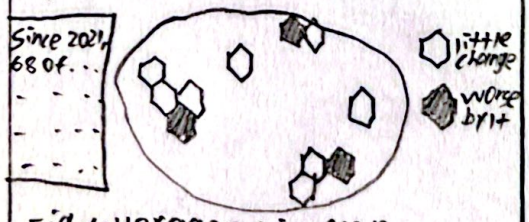


Fig 4: Hexagon bin map, change in.....

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5) A decade of progress reversed



Figure 5: Heatmap, % of track in all five areas.....

6) The postcode gap

The gap between...

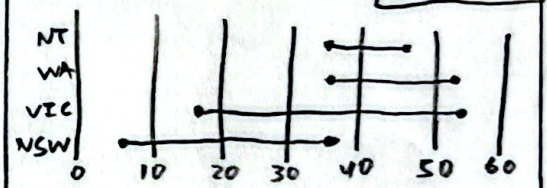
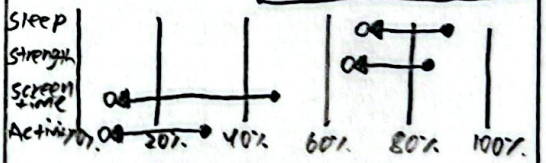


Figure 6: Dumbell chart, most vs least disadvantaged.....

7) Where the guidelines break

Activity and screen...



● Ages 5-8 ○ Ages 15-17

Figure 7: Arrow chart, % meeting each guideline.....

8) Conclusion

place shows where to act. Age shows when

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2 October 2026

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